from chawls in various parts of the city had also fallen for similar fake news, and walked to the same station. Dejected, she sat with her daughter on the side of the platform while Ravi and his two brothers, Basant and Shyam, dived into the angry crowd demanding the police, who had arrived at the scene to disperse them, for answers.

The media, considered essential services, began to aggressively track the story and by mid-afternoon, chaotic images of hordes of angry mobs collected at the station began to appear on various news platforms. Bandra East, Mumbai's western suburb, where the crowds collected, was already classified as a red zone, with high positivity rate. Dispelling all COVID-19-appropriate behaviour of masks and social distancing was a step back for the city in its fight against the virus.

Not only did it throw light on the unfortunate plight of this vulnerable community, but it also exposed the incapability of the state government to act quickly in the interest of the city. Several things could have been done to avoid this: the migrants should have been better provided for by the state government, which was headed by Uddhav Thackeray of the Shiv Sena in an alliance with the Congress and the NCP. On the day itself, it was rather odd to see that none of the crowds making their way to the station were stopped by the Mumbai Police. It was only after the mob got out of control at the station, did the police arrive at the location and lathi-charged. Naturally, it leads one to ask: if the media was able to follow the story since morning, why wasn't the police? Even if we work on the assumption that the cops did not receive the intelligence of such an event taking place, police were stationed all over the city in order to enforce lockdown. Why didn't they act? There were reports in the media that the rumours were spread by local police stations.[6] Were folks instigated to come out on the roads for an underlying political agenda?

From 1 May, the GoI had arranged for Shramik Special trains, which would be operated gradually, in a phased manner, to take the migrants back to their villages. Eighty-five per cent of the cost of these trains would be borne by the Centre, whereas the other 15 per cent would be undertaken by the states. This exercise was taking place in close coordination with the states, where the states would have to raise demands and furnish a list of returnees, on the basis of which the number of trains, their destinations and routes would be planned by the Union Railway Ministry. To get on to the list, migrants would need to pre-register. Extensive safety arrangements to